

HEALTH LITERACY LESSON

Maternal & Child Health Basics

Simple, consistent care during pregnancy and a child's early years supports healthy growth and can help prevent complications.

During pregnancy

- Regular prenatal check-ups help catch and manage problems early.
- Eating a variety of foods, including iron-rich foods like leafy greens, beans, and lean meat, supports both parent and baby.
- Rest and staying well-hydrated matter, especially in hot climates.
- Avoid tobacco, alcohol, and unnecessary medications without medical guidance.

Newborn care basics

- Keep the baby warm, clean, and dry.
- Skin-to-skin contact in the first hours helps regulate a newborn's temperature and supports bonding.
- Breastfeeding, when possible, provides ideal nutrition and antibodies during a baby's first months.

Early childhood milestones to watch for

- By 2 months: responds to sound, follows movement with their eyes
- By 6 months: sits with support, begins babbling
- By 12 months: may stand with support, says simple words like “mama”

Every child develops at their own pace

These milestones are general guides, not strict rules. Missed feedings, unusual lethargy, a high fever in an infant, or a lack of expected developmental progress are all good reasons to check in with a health worker.

This lesson is for general education and does not replace advice from a qualified health professional. If you are concerned about a symptom, please seek medical care.

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